

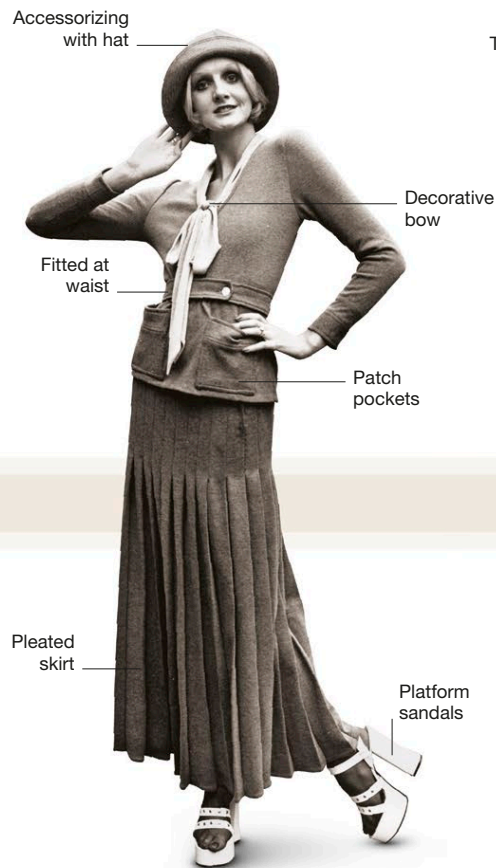
1970–1979

SMART CASUALS

Even dressing down involved staying stylish in the 1970s. Simple cotton, versatile polyester, and comfortable jersey were ideal fabrics for everyday wear, but it was handcrafted knitwear that had the fashion-conscious in a spin. Knitted and crochet garments in bright colours and geometric patterns not only kept women warm but also meant they were in fashion. At this time, colour coordination became possible as mix-and-match collections of separates grew to be commonplace in boutiques and shops. In these one-stop shops customers could get entirely matching outfits without having to rummage around for similar pieces. Those on a tight budget could buy balls of wool and knit or crotchet a whole new wardrobe for themselves. For winter days, women opted for chunky cardigans, wool skirts, jersey tops, and pinafore dresses to look impressively in style with the very minimum of effort. But it was not only fashion designers coming up with the goods – anyone could follow a crochet or knit pattern and create their own clothing.



Lacy confection This crocheted outfit by British knitwear designer Mary Farrin comprises a stylish matching skirt and blouse. Both are crafted from a slub-textured yarn, including intricate, heavy lace detailing around the sleeves, buttons, and hemline.



Maxi skirt Legendary British designer Mary Quant was the creator of this popular look. The pale blue blouse with an oversized bow is coupled with a silky blue, pleated maxi skirt. The hat and platforms set the 1970s seal.



Chorister costume Designed in 1971 by British designer John Bates, this ensemble was named for its similarity to choirboy dress. The tweed maxi dress was worn with a plain-weave rayon blouse, with stiffened, circular collar and cuffs.